

Matías Podeley

Reservoir engineering · Business development · Projects with AI

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Eighteen years working at operating companies, most of them in reservoir engineering: a discipline that demands integrating geology, production, economics and uncertainty to make decisions. Numerical simulation, geostatistics and forecasting on assets across Argentina, Peru, Ecuador and Colombia; later, new-business appraisal through to the investment decision. Today, projects for energy and mining, from idea to execution, with ten tools live at podeley.ar.

Experience

Engineer · podeley.ar (independent), Buenos Aires

since 2026

- Projects for energy and mining, from idea to execution: dashboards, models and agents on public and client data. Ten tools live on podeley.ar.
- Public register of cyber incidents in Argentina's energy sector (fourteen incidents, each row sourced) and research in language-model interpretability, with a published paper and demo.

Energy Transition Engineer, corporate development · Pluspetrol

2022–2026

- Appraisal of new-business projects through to the decision to invest or not. The bulk: sustainable aviation fuel with UOP, Technip and LanzaJet through conceptual engineering; across the table, the largest bioenergy companies in Argentina and Brazil.
- Gas-demand creation projects: ammonia and urea for export off both coasts, and gas solutions for frac fleets.
- Other appraisals: bioenergy with carbon capture and storage (BECCS), helium and uranium.

Reservoir Engineer, new technologies and global reserves · Pluspetrol

2019–2022

- Global reserves progression and asset appraisals; development of the Ichoa play in Bolivia and the Camisea integrated model, on the operator's side.
- In new technologies: underground gas storage.

Reservoir Engineer · Tecpetrol

2014–2019

- Technical representative in the Camisea consortium (blocks 88 and 56, Peru; operator Pluspetrol, with Hunt Oil, SK, Repsol and Sonatrach): migration and maintenance of the full-field simulation model of the giant gas condensate field, and lead of the integrated asset modelling study across GAP, PROSPER and MBAL.
- Development models for Pendare (Colombia) and mature waterflooded fields for Petroamazonas EP (Ecuador): Shushufindi, in the consortium led by Schlumberger (now SLB), and Libertador-Atacapi, through Pardaliservices, with Canacol Energy and Sertecpet.
- Co-creator of Well Expert, the well-data web application the company ended up running on; geosciences focal point for the rollout.

Reservoir Engineer · Pluspetrol

2008–2014

- El Porvenir area (Neuquén basin): studies, reserves progression, development plan, forecasts, waterflood surveillance and workover design.
- Centenario: surveillance and more than 40 well interventions, with field training on rigs, fracturing and production.
- Corporate engineering: valuation support to business development, including the bid for Petroandina Resources that ended in the purchase of its Argentine share for over US\$ 300 million, and the block 1AB integrated study (Marañón basin, Peru).

Instructor and researcher · ITBA, Petroleum Engineering Department

2016–2021, alongside

- Five years teaching Petroleum Project Appraisal; two as a researcher at the Reservoir Simulation Research Center.
- Two publications on applying reservoir simulation to lithium salts.

Earlier: research analyst for an investment bank's equity team (Irevna, 2007–2008) and an internship at Baker Oil Tools (2007).

Education

- Petroleum engineer, Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA), 2008–2009.
- Industrial engineer, ITBA, 2002–2006.
- Energy Innovation and Emerging Technologies Program, Stanford University School of Engineering, 2022.
- Computer science exchange, INSA Lyon, 2006–2007.

Tools and languages

- Petrel, Eclipse and CMG for simulation and geomodelling; GAP, PROSPER and MBAL for integrated asset modelling; Python and GIS on the data side.
- Native Spanish · full professional English · working French.

Selected publications

- "Aplicación de técnicas de simulación de reservorios a la simulación de salares", VII Seminario Internacional del Litio, Salta (in Spanish).
- "Transferencia tecnológica y de RRHH del upstream petrolero al upstream del litio", VI Seminario Internacional del Litio, Catamarca (in Spanish).
- "Implementation and Performance of a Heavy Oil Pilot in Atacapi Field, Ecuador", co-author.
- "Production Analysis and Forecasting of Vaca Muerta Shale Wells in Argentina: Case History-Based", contributor.
- Mechanistic interpretability paper, with PDF and interactive demo: mpodeley.github.io/assembled-thought.